

* Fewer than 30 samples.

Breakout direction. As one might expect, price breaks out upward more often in bull markets and downward more often in bear markets.

Yearly position, performance. There is no clear consensus of where the breakout should be for the best performance, but the lowest range wins in two columns.

Apex distance. Price breaks out of the chart pattern between a median of 57% and 65% of the way to the triangle's apex.

I compared the performance of breakouts before the median distance with those after the median. The bull market, upward breakout had the most samples, so I used those. Do you know what I found? There was absolutely no performance difference. *Sigh.* (Downward breakouts in bull markets favored breakouts closer to the apex with drops averaging 16% to 14%, so it wasn't a complete waste of time.)

Throwbacks and pullbacks. The table shows how often a throwback or pullback appears. On average it'll take about a dozen days to complete the throwback or pullback.

In all columns, when a throwback or pullback appears, performance suffers. For example, triangles in bull markets that throw back (not throw up) see price rise an average of 31%. Without a throwback, the rise averages 48%.

Check for overhead resistance or underlying support before trading. If a congestion zone is nearby (maybe 5% to 10% away), then that could increase the chance of a throwback or pullback.

After a throwback or pullback completes, price trends upward more often than not. Yes, you read that right. Even pullbacks see price rise between 52% and 53% of the time. Of course, that's about random.

Gaps. In three of four columns, a breakout day gap helps performance. Because I calculated performance from the breakout price (which was the opening price the day *after* a gap), you can still participate in the better performance by buying in quickly for those stocks showing a gap.

[Table 65.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.